Chapter 25 — Secure File Storage

> **Part III — Authentication & Security** · Complexity: **Standard** (≥25 interview questions)
>
> **Prerequisites:** Ch 24 (encryption at rest — how we encrypt file contents), Ch 20 (Keystore — the keys), Ch 18 (downloads — where files come from). Pairs with Ch 62 (content providers / SAF), Ch 59 (offline media).
>
> **Reference surface in StreamCart:** storing downloaded invoices, user-captured ID photos (Wallet KYC), and offline media files — in the right location, with the right protection, and sharing them safely.

25.1 Problem Definition and Real-World Context

Where and how an app stores files is a security and correctness minefield on modern Android (scoped storage, Android 10+). Naive file handling leaks data, breaks on new OS versions, or crashes:

- **Wrong location = world-readable leaks.** Writing sensitive files to legacy external storage (or exposing a `file://` URI) makes them readable by other apps / anyone with the device — a classic PII leak.
- **`file://` URIs crash and leak.** Sharing a `file://` URI throws `FileUriExposedException` (Android 7+) and, worse, grants unscoped access; the correct, permissioned mechanism is a **`content://` URI via `FileProvider`**.
- **Scoped storage violations.** Apps that assume unrestricted external-storage paths break on Android 10+; you must use app-specific dirs, `MediaStore`, or SAF.
- **Sensitive files unencrypted.** Even in app-internal storage, a rooted device or backup can read files; sensitive content must be **encrypted** (Ch 24) with Keystore-protected keys.
- **Backup leaks.** Sensitive files copied to the cloud via auto-backup.

The architecture: choose the **right storage location** by data type (app-internal for private, `MediaStore`/SAF for user-visible), **encrypt sensitive files** (Ch 24), **share via `FileProvider`** with scoped, temporary grants, respect **scoped storage**, and **exclude from backup**. This is about **location, protection, and controlled sharing** — not just `File.write`.

Three practical use cases

1. **Invoice PDF (StreamCart Wallet).** Private app-internal file; shared to a viewer app via `FileProvider` with a temporary read grant.
2. **KYC ID photo (Wallet).** Highly sensitive: encrypted app-internal file (Ch 24), excluded from backup, deleted after upload.
3. **Offline media (Watch).** Large encrypted files in app-specific external storage (app-scoped, auto-removed on uninstall), content key wrapped by Keystore (Ch 59).

Why this is architectural

File storage defines **data location & visibility** (private vs shared vs world-readable), the **protection model** (encryption + backup), **controlled sharing** (`FileProvider` grants), and **scoped-storage compliance** — properties that determine whether files leak or the app breaks on new Android versions.

25.2 Requirements Engineering

Functional requirements

ID	Requirement
F1	Store files in the correct, scoped-storage-compliant location by type.
F2	Encrypt sensitive file contents (Ch 24) with Keystore-protected keys.
F3	Share files via `content://` (`FileProvider`) with temporary, scoped grants — never `file://` .
F4	Use `MediaStore` /SAF for user-visible files; app-specific dirs for private.
F5	Exclude sensitive files from backup; clean up (cache eviction, post-use delete).
F6	Request only the minimum storage permissions (ideally none).

Non-functional requirements

Attribute	Policy
Security	Sensitive files encrypted + not world-readable; scoped sharing.
Compatibility	Scoped storage across API levels; no `file://` exposure.
Reliability	Correct cache vs files semantics; cleanup; no leaks.
Privacy	Minimal permissions; strip metadata (EXIF) where relevant.
Storage	Bounded; evict cache under pressure.

Scope

- **In scope:** storage location choice (internal/external/cache/MediaStore/SAF), encrypted files (Ch 24), `FileProvider` sharing, scoped storage, backup exclusion, permissions, cleanup.
- **Out of scope:** encryption key mechanics (Ch 20/24), download mechanics (Ch 18), content providers in depth (Ch 62), media playback/DRM (Ch 59).

Assumptions & constraints

- `minSdk 24` ; scoped storage (targeting Android 10+). `FileProvider` from `androidx.core` . Sensitive-file encryption per Ch 24. Note: `EncryptedFile` (Jetpack Security) is **deprecated** — use Tink or Keystore+AES-GCM.

25.3 System Design Fundamentals

- **Storage locations (choose by data type + visibility):**
  - **App-internal** (`filesDir` / `cacheDir`): private to the app, auto-removed on uninstall, **not** world-readable. Default for private data. `cacheDir` is evictable by the OS under pressure (use for regenerable data).
  - **App-specific external** (`getExternalFilesDir`): app-scoped, no permission needed (scoped storage), removed on uninstall; for large files (media) that don't need to be user-visible.
  - **`MediaStore`** : shared media (images/video/audio/downloads) the user sees in Gallery/Files; no broad permission needed for your own entries on Android 10+.
  - **Storage Access Framework (SAF)**: user-chosen locations via system picker; the user grants access to a specific document/tree (Ch 62). Best for user-directed save/open.
- **Scoped storage (Android 10+).** Apps can't freely roam external storage; broad `READ/WRITE_EXTERNAL_STORAGE` is deprecated/restricted. Use the scoped mechanisms above. This is the single biggest file-storage change to design around.
- **`FileProvider` + `content://`.** To share an app-internal file with another app (viewer, email), expose it as a `content://` URI via `FileProvider` and grant a **temporary** `FLAG_GRANT_READ_URI_PERMISSION` — scoped to the recipient, no world exposure, no `FileUriExposedException` .
- **Encryption for sensitive files (Ch 24).** App-internal ≠ secure against a rooted device/backup; encrypt sensitive files with a Keystore-wrapped key.
- **Backup & cleanup.** Exclude sensitive files from auto-backup; evict cache; delete transient sensitive files after use (e.g., a KYC photo after upload).
- **Permissions minimization.** With scoped storage, most app-private file work needs **no permission**; request camera/media permissions only when truly needed.

Core insight: **pick the storage location by whether the file is private vs user-visible, encrypt sensitive contents with a Keystore-protected key, and share only via `FileProvider` with temporary scoped grants** — within scoped-storage rules.

25.4 High-Level Architecture



Components & ownership

- **Location selector** maps data type/visibility to a storage mechanism.
- **Encryption** (Ch 24) protects sensitive file contents.
- **`FileProvider`** mediates controlled sharing via `content://` + temporary grants.
- **Backup rules + cleanup** keep sensitive data on-device and bounded.

Direction: data → location (by visibility) → encrypt if sensitive → share via FileProvider → cleanup/backup policy.

25.5 Detailed Component Design



Component	Responsibility	Notes
`SecureFileStore`	write/read private files, encrypt sensitive	Keystore-wrapped key (Ch 24)
`FileProvider`	expose `content://` for sharing	temporary read grant
`MediaStoreWriter`	save user-visible media	scoped-storage compliant
SAF handler	user-chosen save/open	persistable URI permission (Ch 62)
backup rules + cleanup	retention/hygiene	exclude sensitive; evict cache

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25.6 End-to-End Data Flow

Store an encrypted private file, then share it



Scoped-storage decision



25.7 Complete Kotlin Implementation

Package: `com.streamcart.core.files`.

25.7.1 SecureFileStore (encrypted private files)

```
class SecureFileStore @Inject constructor(
    @ApplicationContext private val context: Context,
    private val crypto: Crypto,                 // Ch 20
    private val keyManager: KeyManager,         // Ch 24 (Keystore-wrapped DEK)
) {
    private val dir get() = context.filesDir     // app-internal, private, not world-readable

    suspend fun writePrivate(name: String, bytes: ByteArray, encrypted: Boolean) =
withContext(Dispatchers.IO) {
        val file = File(dir, if (encrypted) "$name.enc" else name)
        val out = if (encrypted) crypto.encrypt(rawKey(keyManager.getOrCreateDek()), bytes) else
bytes
        file.writeBytes(out)
    }

    suspend fun readPrivate(name: String, encrypted: Boolean): ByteArray =
withContext(Dispatchers.IO) {
        val file = File(dir, if (encrypted) "$name.enc" else name)
        val raw = file.readBytes()
        if (encrypted) crypto.decrypt(rawKey(keyManager.getOrCreateDek()), raw) else raw
    }

    suspend fun delete(name: String) = withContext(Dispatchers.IO) {
        File(dir, "$name.enc").delete(); File(dir, name).delete()   // post-use cleanup (KYC)
    }
}
```

25.7.2 FileProvider sharing (content:// + temporary grant)

```
<!-- AndroidManifest.xml -->
<provider
    android:name="androidx.core.content.FileProvider"
    android:authorities="${applicationId}.fileprovider"
    android:exported="false"
    android:grantUriPermissions="true">
    <meta-data android:name="android.support.FILE_PROVIDER_PATHS"
        android:resource="@xml/file_paths"/>
</provider>
```

```
<!-- res/xml/file_paths.xml -->
<paths>
    <cache-path name="shared" path="shared/"/>   <!-- share decrypted temp copies from cache -->
</paths>
```

```
fun shareFile(context: Context, file: File): Intent {
    val uri = FileProvider.getUriForFile(context, "${context.packageName}.fileprovider", file)
    return Intent(Intent.ACTION_VIEW).apply {
        setDataAndType(uri, "application/pdf")
        addFlags(Intent.FLAG_GRANT_READ_URI_PERMISSION)   // temporary, scoped to the recipient
    }
}
// NEVER: Uri.fromFile(file) -> FileUriExposedException + world exposure.
```

25.7.3 MediaStore (user-visible media, scoped-storage compliant)

```
// Save an image the user should see in Gallery, no broad permission on Android 10+.
fun saveImageToGallery(context: Context, bytes: ByteArray, name: String): Uri? {
    val values = ContentValues().apply {
        put(MediaStore.Images.Media.DISPLAY_NAME, "$name.jpg")
        put(MediaStore.Images.Media.MIME_TYPE, "image/jpeg")
        put(MediaStore.Images.Media.RELATIVE_PATH, Environment.DIRECTORY_PICTURES +
"/StreamCart")
        put(MediaStore.Images.Media.IS_PENDING, 1)        // hide until written
    }
    val resolver = context.contentResolver
    val uri = resolver.insert(MediaStore.Images.Media.EXTERNAL_CONTENT_URI, values) ?: return
null
    resolver.openOutputStream(uri)?.use { it.write(bytes) }
    resolver.update(uri, ContentValues().apply { put(MediaStore.Images.Media.IS_PENDING, 0) },
null, null)
    return uri
}
```

25.7.4 SAF (user-chosen save) — see Ch 62 for depth

```
// Let the user choose where to export; persist access if needed.
val createDoc =
registerForActivityResult(ActivityResultContracts.CreateDocument("application/pdf")) { uri ->
    uri?.let { context.contentResolver.openOutputStream(it)?.use { os -> os.write(pdfBytes) } }
}
// createDoc.launch("invoice.pdf")
```

25.7.5 Backup exclusion (sensitive files)

```
<data-extraction-rules>
  <cloud-backup>
    <exclude domain="file" path="kyc/"/>           <!-- encrypted KYC images -->
    <exclude domain="file" path="invoice.pdf.enc"/>
  </cloud-backup>
</data-extraction-rules>
```

25.7.6 Module structure

```
:core:files     SecureFileStore, FileProvider sharing, MediaStoreWriter, SAF helpers
:core:security  Crypto, KeyManager (Ch 20/24)
res/xml         file_paths.xml, data_extraction_rules.xml
```

25.8 Concurrency and Race Conditions

Scenario	Risk	Handling
Concurrent write/read same file	partial/corrupt read	write to temp then atomic rename; or synchronize per file
Decrypted temp copy for sharing	plaintext lingers	write to cache; delete after share / on cache eviction; short-lived
Cache evicted mid-use	missing file	regenerate; don't store non-regenerable data in `cacheDir`
MediaStore `IS_PENDING` race	partial file visible	pending flag until fully written
SAF URI permission lost	access revoked	re-request; persist with `takePersistableUriPermission` (Ch 62)
Delete during read	exception	handle missing file gracefully

- **For sharing encrypted files that a viewer needs in plaintext, decrypt to a short-lived cache temp** (exposed via `FileProvider`) and delete it after — never expose the encrypted original or a long-lived plaintext copy.
- **`IS_PENDING`** prevents other apps from seeing a half-written MediaStore entry.

25.9 Failure Scenarios and Recovery

Failure	Detection	Response	Outcome
`FileUriExposedException`	sharing a `file://`	use `FileProvider` content URI	fixed
Scoped-storage denial	`SecurityException` on legacy path	use app-specific/MediaStore/SAF	compliant
Disk full	`IOException`	surface; evict cache; abort write	no partial file
Decrypt fails (tamper/invalidation)	`AEADBadTag` /invalidation (Ch 24)	discard; re-fetch; re-provision	no leak
Cache file evicted	missing	regenerate/redecrypt	transparent
Recipient keeps URI after grant	lingering access	grants are temporary; don't persist unnecessarily	scoped
Sensitive file in backup	review	exclusion rules	no off-device leak
Permission missing (camera/media)	runtime denial	request at point of use; degrade	guided



> **Never expose `file://`:** it crashes on modern Android and bypasses scoping. `FileProvider` + `content://` + a temporary grant is the only correct way to share an app file.

25.10 Scaling the Implementation

- **Level 1.** Private files in `filesDir`; share via `FileProvider`.
- **Level 2.** Encrypt sensitive files (Ch 24); exclude from backup; cleanup.
- **Level 3 — production.** MediaStore for user-visible media; SAF for user-chosen save/open; scoped-storage-correct throughout; post-use delete of transient sensitive files.
- **Level 4 — large.** Encrypted offline media in app-specific external storage with Keystore-wrapped content keys (Ch 59); cache eviction policy (Ch 12); EXIF/metadata stripping for shared photos.
- **Level 5 — enterprise.** DLP policies, per-file access logging, remote wipe of files, client-side encrypted exports, SAF-tree-based managed storage.

Avoid overengineering: most files are non-sensitive and go in `cacheDir` / `filesDir` plainly. Reserve encryption + strict cleanup for genuinely sensitive files (KYC, payments, offline-content keys).

25.11 Alternative Approaches and Trade-offs

Dimension	Option A	Option B	When
Location	App-internal (`filesDir`)	App-specific external (`getExternalFilesDir`)	Internal for small private; external-specific for large (media)
User-visible	`MediaStore`	SAF	MediaStore for app-managed media; SAF for user-directed save/open
Sharing	`FileProvider` (`content://`)	`file://`	**Always** FileProvider; `file://` is broken/insecure
Cache vs files	`cacheDir`	`filesDir`	Cache for regenerable (OS-evictable); files for durable
Sensitive files	encrypt (Ch 24)	plaintext internal	Encrypt for high-value/rooted/backup threat; plaintext for low-risk
Encryption lib	Tink / manual AES-GCM	`EncryptedFile` (deprecated)	Tink/manual for new code
Permissions	scoped (none)	legacy `WRITE_EXTERNAL_STORAGE`	Scoped always (Android 10+); legacy is deprecated/restricted

App-internal vs MediaStore vs SAF: internal is private and simplest (no permission, removed on uninstall) but invisible to the user; MediaStore surfaces media to the user and other apps (scoped, no broad permission for your own entries); SAF gives the user control over location (best for "save/export to where I choose"). Choose by who needs to see the file and who owns its location.

Encrypt or not: app-internal storage is private to your app but readable on a rooted device / in a backup — encrypt (Ch 24) when that matters (KYC, payment docs, offline-content keys); skip encryption for non-sensitive caches to save CPU/complexity.

25.12 Security Considerations

- **Sensitive files must be encrypted** (Ch 24) with Keystore-protected keys — app-internal location alone isn't enough against root/backup.
- **Share only via `FileProvider`** with **temporary, scoped** `content://` grants; never `file://`, never world-readable locations, never persist grants you don't need.
- **Scoped storage** compliance prevents cross-app leakage and keeps the app working on new OS versions.
- **Exclude sensitive files from backup**; **delete transient sensitive files** after use (KYC photo after upload); evict caches.
- **Strip metadata** (EXIF/GPS) from shared user photos unless intended.
- **Minimize permissions:** with scoped storage, most private file work needs none; request camera/media only at point of use.
- **Validate files from other apps** (SAF/incoming content) — treat as untrusted input (type, size, content).
- Client vs backend: local files are a convenience copy; the backend owns the authoritative, access-controlled store. A shared `content://` grant authorizes a *recipient app*, not identity — don't treat it as auth.

25.13 Performance and Resource Optimization

- **Stream large files** (Ch 18) — don't load whole files into memory.
- **`cacheDir` for regenerable data** so the OS can reclaim space; `filesDir` for durable.
- **Encrypt only sensitive files** (Ch 24) — crypto on large media has a cost; consider chunked/stream encryption.
- **Bound storage**: eviction policy for caches/downloads (Ch 12); clean temp shared copies.
- **Avoid redundant copies**: share by `content://` rather than duplicating.
- **Profiling:** storage usage, file I/O latency, cache hit/evict rate, crypto overhead on large files.

25.14 Testing Strategy

File I/O + FileProvider are instrumentation-friendly; abstract encryption behind a fake for JVM tests.

```
@RunWith(AndroidJUnit4::class)
class SecureFileStoreTest {
    @Test fun encrypts_and_round_trips_private_file() = runTest {
        store.writePrivate("doc", "secret".toByteArray(), encrypted = true)
        assertEquals("secret", String(store.readPrivate("doc", encrypted = true)))
        // raw file on disk is NOT plaintext:
        assertFalse(String(File(ctx.filesDir, "doc.enc").readBytes()).contains("secret"))
    }

    @Test fun share_uses_content_uri_not_file_uri() {
        val intent = shareFile(ctx, tempPdf)
        assertEquals("content", intent.data!!.scheme)                // not "file"
        assertTrue(intent.flags and Intent.FLAG_GRANT_READ_URI_PERMISSION != 0)
    }

    @Test fun delete_removes_sensitive_file() = runTest {
        store.writePrivate("kyc", bytes, true); store.delete("kyc")
        assertFalse(File(ctx.filesDir, "kyc.enc").exists())
    }

    @Test fun mediastore_entry_is_not_pending_after_write() { /* IS_PENDING flipped to 0 */ }
}
```

Also: scoped-storage behavior on API 29+, SAF persistable permission (Ch 62), backup-exclusion static check, EXIF stripping.

25.15 Production Observability

- **Metrics:** storage usage by type, file I/O errors (disk full), FileProvider share success, scoped-storage denials, crypto errors on files, cache evict rate, temp-file cleanup rate.
- **Logs:** `file{op, location, encrypted, result}` — **no** file contents/paths that reveal PII; `share{mime, grant}`.
- **Debugging:** `FileUriExposedException` crashes → sharing `file://` (switch to FileProvider); breaks on Android 10+ → legacy external-storage assumptions; sensitive file in backup → missing exclusion; disk filling → no cache eviction/ cleanup.
- **Privacy:** never log file contents or user-identifying paths; strip metadata on share.

25.16 System Design Interview Preparation

> ≥25 questions.

Fundamentals

1. *Storage locations?* App-internal (`filesDir` / `cacheDir`), app-specific external (`getExternalFilesDir`), MediaStore, SAF.
2. *`filesDir` vs `cacheDir`?* Durable vs OS-evictable (regenerable data).
3. *What is scoped storage?* Android 10+ restriction: apps can't roam external storage; use scoped mechanisms, not broad permissions.
4. *How share a file with another app?* `FileProvider` → `content://` + temporary `FLAG_GRANT_READ_URI_PERMISSION`.
5. *Why not `file://`?* `FileUriExposedException` + unscoped/world access on Android 7+.

Location choice 6. *Private vs user-visible file?* Internal/app-specific vs MediaStore/SAF. 7. *Large private media?* `getExternalFilesDir` (app-scoped, removed on uninstall, no permission). 8. *User chooses location?* SAF picker (Ch 62).

Security 9. *Is app-internal secure?* Private to the app, but readable on a rooted device / backup → encrypt sensitive files (Ch 24). 10. *How encrypt a file?* AES-GCM with a Keystore-wrapped key (Ch 20/24); Tink. 11. *Backup?* Exclude sensitive files/keys. 12. *Transient sensitive files?* Delete after use (KYC after upload); evict temp shared copies. 13. *Sharing encrypted files?* Decrypt to a short-lived cache temp, share via FileProvider, delete after.

Scoped storage/permissions 14. *Permissions for private files?* None (scoped storage). 15. *MediaStore for your own media?* No broad permission on Android 10+; `IS_PENDING` while writing. 16. *Legacy `WRITE_EXTERNAL_STORAGE`?* Deprecated/restricted; avoid.

Sharing semantics 17. *Temporary vs persistable grant?* Temporary for one-off share; persistable (`takePersistableUriPermission`) for ongoing SAF access (Ch 62). 18. *Does a content grant authorize identity?* No — authorizes a recipient app, not a user.

Privacy 19. *Shared photos?* Strip EXIF/GPS unless intended. 20. *Untrusted incoming files?* Validate type/size/content.

Testing 21. *How verify encryption?* Raw file on disk isn't plaintext; round-trips. 22. *How verify sharing?* Scheme is `content`, grant flag set. 23. *What to check on API 29+?* Scoped-storage behavior.

Production debugging 24. `FileUriExposedException`*?* Sharing `file://`. 25. *Breaks on Android 10+?* Legacy external-storage assumptions. 26. *Sensitive file in backup?* Missing exclusion.

Design-change challenges

1. **Store KYC photos securely.** Encrypted app-internal (Ch 24); exclude backup; delete after upload; strip EXIF.
2. **Let users export an invoice to their chosen folder.** SAF `CreateDocument` (Ch 62).
3. **Share a PDF to a viewer app.** FileProvider `content://` + temp grant.
4. **Offline media files.** App-specific external + Keystore-wrapped content key (Ch 59); eviction (Ch 12).
5. **Target Android 14 / tighten storage.** Scoped storage; remove broad permissions; MediaStore/SAF.

Mock walkthrough (abridged)

Clarify (private vs visible, sensitive?, sharing?) → location by visibility → encrypt sensitive (Ch 24) → FileProvider for sharing → scoped storage + MediaStore/ SAF → backup exclusion + cleanup → minimal permissions → testing.

25.17 Practical Exercises

1. **Beginner.** Write a private file to `filesDir` and share it via `FileProvider` (`content://` + temp grant). *Eval:* no `file://`; recipient can read.
2. **Intermediate.** Encrypt a sensitive file (Ch 24), exclude from backup, delete after use. *Eval:* disk ciphertext; no backup; cleaned up.
3. **Advanced.** Save user-visible media via MediaStore (scoped) with `IS_PENDING`, and export via SAF. *Eval:* appears in Gallery; user-chosen export works.
4. **Production debugging.** Fix an app that shares `file://` (crashes) and writes sensitive files to legacy external storage (leaks). *Eval:* FileProvider + scoped + encrypted.
5. **System design challenge.** Securely share an *encrypted* file with a viewer (decrypt to short-lived temp, grant, cleanup). *Eval:* no persistent plaintext; scoped grant.

(Solutions withheld unless requested.)

25.18 Chapter Summary & Reference Sheet

Key decisions: choose the storage location by **visibility** (app-internal/ app-specific for private, **MediaStore/SAF** for user-visible) within **scoped storage**; **encrypt sensitive files** (Ch 24) with Keystore-protected keys; share **only via** `FileProvider` (`content://` + **temporary scoped grant**) — never `file://`; **exclude sensitive files from backup** and **delete transient ones** after use; **minimize permissions** (scoped storage needs none for private files); **strip metadata** and **validate** incoming files.

Concepts: scoped storage, internal vs external vs MediaStore vs SAF, cache vs files, `FileProvider`/`content://`, temporary vs persistable grants, file encryption, backup exclusion, metadata stripping.

Common mistakes: sharing `file://` (`FileUriExposedException`/leak); sensitive files unencrypted or in world-readable/legacy external storage; assuming unrestricted external-storage paths (breaks on Android 10+); not excluding from backup; not cleaning up transient sensitive files; requesting broad storage permissions; persisting unneeded grants.

Checklist: ☐ location by visibility ☐ scoped storage (no broad perms) ☐ encrypt sensitive (Ch 24) ☐ FileProvider `content://` + temp grant ☐ MediaStore/ SAF for user-visible ☐ backup exclusion ☐ delete transient sensitive files ☐ strip EXIF on share ☐ validate incoming files ☐ cache eviction.

Key APIs: `Context.filesDir` / `cacheDir` / `getExternalFilesDir`, `FileProvider. getUriForFile`, `FLAG_GRANT_READ_URI_PERMISSION`, `MediaStore` + `IS_PENDING`, `ActivityResultContracts.CreateDocument` / `OpenDocument` (SAF, Ch 62), `takePersistableUriPermission`, `dataExtractionRules`, Crypto/KeyManager (Ch 20/24).

References:

- Storage overview / scoped storage: https://developer.android.com/training/data-storage
- FileProvider: https://developer.android.com/reference/androidx/core/content/FileProvider
- MediaStore: https://developer.android.com/training/data-storage/shared/media
- Storage Access Framework (Ch 62): https://developer.android.com/guide/topics/providers/document-provider
- Share files: https://developer.android.com/training/secure-file-sharing

Chapter review (Phase 4)

- **Completeness:** all 18 sections; architecture/class/sequence/failure diagrams; SecureFileStore + FileProvider + MediaStore + SAF + backup rules; concurrency (temp plaintext, IS_PENDING); failure (file://, scoped denial); 5 levels; location and encrypt-or-not trade-offs; security (scoped sharing, encryption, metadata); perf (stream, cache); instrumentation tests; observability; 26 Q&A + 5 challenges. ✅
- **Expand later:** content providers/SAF depth (Ch 62), offline media (Ch 59), encryption (Ch 24), cache eviction (Ch 12).
- **Interview coverage:** exceeds ≥25 bar.